

31/10/2025

Siege, Mutinied, Exactions, Grumbled, Abated

1 Siege (घेराबंदी) (Noun) (seej) — *Serious, tense*

- **Meaning (English):** A military operation where forces surround a place to cut off supplies, forcing surrender.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** एक सैन्य कार्यवाही जिसमें किसी स्थान को चारों ओर से घेरकर उसकी आपूर्ति रोक दी जाती है ताकि आत्मसमर्पण कराया जा सके।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *sedere* (to sit) → **Old French sege** → Middle English *siege* → **Modern English siege**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** blockade, encirclement, assault
 - **Antonyms:** retreat, withdrawal, liberation
- **Connotation:** Serious and strategic; often used metaphorically for persistent pressure.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Soldiers surrounding a fort, cutting off food and water supplies.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

The siege of Troy remains one of history's most iconic tales of endurance and strategy. In modern times, "siege" extends beyond warfare—corporate, emotional, or social sieges symbolize relentless challenges that test persistence. Understanding how one endures a siege, literal or figurative, reveals much about human resilience and adaptability.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *The city was under siege for weeks.* (शहर कई हफ्तों तक घेराबंदी में था।)
-  *They siege the castle yesterday. → They laid siege to the castle yesterday.*

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- When facing a personal or professional siege—a period of sustained pressure or challenge—don't surrender your focus. Instead, fortify your mental defenses through discipline and calm planning. Identify your emotional weak points, strengthen them with routine, and remember that every siege eventually breaks when persistence meets patience.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- *The castle fell after a long siege.* (लंबी घेराबंदी के बाद किला गिर गया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): The castle
 - V (Verb – Intransitive): fell
 - (Prepositional Phrase of Time/Condition): after a long siege

- **Common Collocations:**

- lay siege, under siege, siege mentality

- **My Statement:**

- The general commanded his troops to lay siege in the middle of the night.
- We have been under siege for hours now, and still there is no contact for reinforcements.
- They were broken down physically and mentally after a week-long siege.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

2 Mutinied (विद्रोह किया) (Verb – Past Form) (*myoo-tuh-need*) — *Defiant, rebellious*

- **Meaning (English):** Refused to obey authority, especially by soldiers or sailors against their officers.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** आदेश या सत्ता के खिलाफ बगावत करना, विशेष रूप से सैनिकों या नाविकों द्वारा।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *movēre* (to move) → Old French *mutiner* (to revolt) → English *mutiny* → *mutinied* (past form)
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** rebelled, revolted, defied
 - **Antonyms:** obeyed, complied, conformed
- **Connotation:** Negative when chaotic; positive when moral defiance.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Sailors raising weapons against their captain on a stormy night.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

When workers mutinied against unfair labor practices, it symbolized more than defiance—it represented a stand for dignity. Mutinies often arise from prolonged neglect of justice. In historical and organizational contexts, understanding the causes behind

mutiny helps leaders balance authority with empathy, preventing rebellion through fairness and inclusion.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *The sailors mutinied against their captain.* (नाविकों ने अपने कप्तान के खिलाफ विद्रोह किया।)
-  *They did mutiny yesterday. → They mutinied yesterday.*

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- When your mind feels mutinied—rebellious against discipline or focus—pause and regain command. Just as sailors revolt when leadership falters, your thoughts revolt when purpose weakens. Reassert control with clarity and consistency. Remind yourself why you started, and channel that rebellion into renewed determination instead of chaos.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- *The sailors mutinied after months without pay.* (कई महीनों तक वेतन न मिलने के बाद नाविकों ने विद्रोह किया।)

- **Grammar Breakdown:**

- S (Subject): The sailors
- V (Verb – Intransitive): mutinied
- (Adverbial Clause of Time): after months without pay

- **Common Collocations:**

- mutinied against, mutinied crew, mutinied soldiers

- **My Statement:**

- The sailors mutinied against their captain when they were forced to work under freezing temperatures.
- If you consistently mutiny against rational convictions, someone else will command you.
- The citizens mutinied against the authorities to reclaim their rights and restore their freedom.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

3 Exactions (अत्याचार / अधिक वसूली) (Noun – Plural) (*ig-zak-shuhnz*) — Severe, demanding

- **Meaning (English):** The act of demanding money, service, or obedience unfairly or harshly.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** जबरन या अनुचित रूप से धन, सेवा या आज्ञा की मांग करना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *exigere* (to demand) → **Old French *exaction*** → English *exaction*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** extortion, demand, oppression
 - **Antonyms:** generosity, leniency, fairness
- **Connotation:** Negative — implies unfair or excessive demands.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A corrupt tax collector demanding payment from struggling villagers.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Exactions are not just fiscal—they represent moral burdens imposed by authority or expectation. In modern governance and corporate systems, such pressures manifest as unethical demands or unreasonable performance goals. Recognizing and addressing these exactions ensures justice, balance, and sustainability in relationships between leaders and those they lead.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *Citizens suffered under the exactions of corrupt officials.* (नागरिक भ्रष्ट अधिकारियों की अत्याचारपूर्ण मांगों से पीड़ित थे।)
-  *He make exaction from them. → He made exactions from them.*

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- When life feels burdened by exactions—unfair demands on your time, energy, or emotions—learn to draw boundaries. Not every request deserves compliance. Like a ruler who overtaxes loses loyalty, you lose peace when you overextend. Choose your commitments wisely and give only where it aligns with your values and purpose.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- *The peasants revolted against the king's harsh exactions.* (किसानों ने राजा की कठोर मांगों के खिलाफ विद्रोह किया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): The peasants
 - V (Verb – Intransitive): revolted
 - (Prepositional Phrase of Opposition): against the king's harsh exactions

- **Common Collocations:**

- harsh exactions, royal exactions, tax exactions

- **My Statement:**

- The harsh exactions of the British were not tolerated by the public.
- We cannot live under such exactions where barely anything is left for ourselves.
- He was the one who started the exaction against us when we were already in trouble.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

4 Grumbled (बड़बड़ाया / शिकायत की) (Verb – Past Form) (*grum-buhld*) — *Irritated, low-toned*

- **Meaning (English):** To complain in a low voice or express dissatisfaction quietly.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** धीरे-धीरे असंतोष प्रकट करना या बड़बड़ाना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Imitative origin (sound-based) → **Middle English *gromlen*** → Modern English *grumble* → ***grumbled***
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** complained, murmured, moaned
 - **Antonyms:** praised, applauded, accepted
- **Connotation:** Mildly negative; conveys dissatisfaction without strong confrontation.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** An old man muttering to himself about rising prices.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Even in disciplined workplaces, employees often grumbled quietly about unfair policies. These subdued expressions of discontent highlight a deeper communication gap between leaders and their teams. Addressing such murmurs early can prevent resentment from festering, fostering a culture of openness and trust instead of passive resistance.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *He grumbled about the food being cold.* (उसने खाने के ठंडे होने की शिकायत की।)
-  *He grumble always. → He always grumbles.*

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- When you grumble about challenges, you drain the energy that could solve them. Replace complaints with constructive reflection. Note what's bothering you, then shift to action—fix, adapt, or move on. Every time you stop grumbling and start acting, you reclaim control over your emotions and strengthen resilience.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- *She grumbled about her workload all day.* (वह पूरे दिन अपने काम के बोझ की शिकायत करती रही।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Intransitive): grumbled
 - (Prepositional Phrase of Cause/Topic): about her workload
 - (Adverbial Phrase of Time): all day

- **Common Collocations:**

- grumbled about, constantly grumbled, grumbled softly

- **My Statement:**

- She grumbled about her life decisions when she was alone.
- After being unfairly charged, the passenger grumbled softly after leaving the vehicle.
- All the peasants constantly grumbled about the unfair exactions demanded of them.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

5 Abated (कम हुआ / घटा) (Verb – Past Form) (*uh-bay-tid*) — Neutral, relieving

- **Meaning (English):** To become less intense, widespread, or severe.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी चीज़ का कम या शांत हो जाना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *battuere* (to beat down) → **Old French *abattre*** → English *abate* → ***abated***
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** diminished, subsided, decreased
 - **Antonyms:** intensified, increased, escalated
- **Connotation:** Positive when referring to relief; neutral in tone overall.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** The storm clouds dispersing after heavy rain.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

The tension abated once transparent communication was restored. In both nature and human affairs, abatement represents balance returning after excess. Whether it's a financial crisis, emotional turbulence, or social unrest, calmness after intensity signals adaptation—a natural rhythm where energy resets for renewal.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- ☒ *The pain abated after medication.* (दवा के बाद दर्द कम हो गया।)

- **✗** *He abate the noise.* → *He abated the noise.*

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- When chaos surrounds you, wait for the storm to abate before making critical decisions. Acting in haste often worsens the situation. Patience allows emotions and pressures to settle, revealing clarity. Remember—calmness is not weakness; it's the sign of strength that emerges once the noise has finally abated.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- *The storm finally abated after hours of thunder.* (कई घंटों की गरज के बाद तूफान आखिरकार शांत हुआ।)

- **Grammar Breakdown:**

- S (Subject): The storm
- V (Verb – Intransitive): abated
- (Adverb of Time): finally
- (Adverbial Clause of Time): after hours of thunder

- **Common Collocations:**

- storm abated, pain abated, fear abated

- **My Statement:**

- The pain abated after she received pain injections in the hospital.
- After years of preparation, his fear abated before the exam.
- As she entered the stage and began speaking, all her fear abated as if it had never existed.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]